

Priyanikha Jayakumar

Ph.D. in Natural Sciences

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Profile

Research scientist with strong interest in revolutionizing global healthcare through technology and data management. Goal-driven, strong international background, organized and efficient team player with excellent communication and interpersonal skills. I am seeking opportunities in research fields with priority on improving health and achieving health equity for everyone.

Key Skills

- Management of multidisciplinary projects
- Data management, analysis, interpretation & visualization
- Strong analytical, organizational & executorial skills
- Clear communication and collaboration skills

IT Skills

Microsoft Office	●●●●●
Data analysis and visualization (R, Fiji, FlowJo)	●●●●●
BioRender	●●●●●
Bioinformatics	●●●●●

Language skills

English | Native

German | A2

Malay | Native

Interests

Hiking, reading, yoga

Science outreach programs and movements concerning future of food production

Work Experience

Doctoral thesis

Department of Quantitative Biomedicine | University of Zurich | Nov 2017 – Present

- Led 2 independent projects with 2 scientific publications in line
- Established a novel scientific tool and analysis workflow that allows high-throughput measurement of gene activity of bacterial cells at the single-cell level
- 4+ years of experience in high quantitative data analysis, interpretation and visualization
- Currently involved in developing a microscopy project workflow that focuses on analysis pipeline for future batch processing of high-volume data
- Active engagement in problem-solving discussions requiring critical and innovative thinking
- Led an international research partnership across multiple disciplines to develop mathematical models in support of experimental data on clinical studies
- Presented research findings at 4 international conferences and 3 mini-symposiums, and won the best presentation award at the symposium organized by Zurich Graduate School
- Supervised 2 Master's students on their research theses, organized and led 3 mini-research projects and 3 practical courses for both Master's and Bachelor's students

Education

Ph.D. Candidate in Evolutionary Microbiology | *University of Zurich* | Nov 2017 – present

MRes in Biomedical Research (Distinction) | *Imperial College London* | Oct 2016 – Sep 2017

BSc (Hons) in Microbiology (1st Class) | *Imperial College London* | Nov 2013 – Jul 2016

Extracurricular Activities

Member of Junior Scientist Organization | *University of Zurich* | 2021 – Present

- Organized scientific and career workshops to connect junior scientists and professionals in academia and non-academic industries (e.g., pharmaceutical and consulting firms)
- Involved in budget planning and grant writing applications for scientific events
- Actively communicated the needs of junior researchers to the university through participation in politics concerning research development and student affairs

PhD Mentoring Program | *Graduate Campus, ETH and University of Zurich* | 2020 – Present

- Mentored 2 junior PhD students on a one-to-one basis, with a focus on their personal growth
- Provided support on career planning, networking, work-life balance and funding opportunities

Co-organizer of Biomedical Research practical course | *University of Zurich* | 2019 – 2021

- Led Master's and Bachelor's students on multiple 1-month long research projects
- Guided students to develop scientific hypotheses, experimental planning, data analysis, scientific writing and presentations

School Plus Project Coordinator | *Imperial College London* | 2015 – 2017

- Provided weekly tutoring to primary school students on Mathematics, Science and English
- Organized scientific interactive booths to provide science capital to kids and young parents

Imperial Horizons | *Imperial College London* | 2013 – 2015

- Organized exhibitions to communicate global issues such as diabetes and global warming
- Led a research team on issues concerning gender inequality in employment and workplace

Awards

Ian Clark Memorial Prize for excellence in microbiology | *Imperial College London* | 2016

President's Scholarship for academic excellence | *Imperial College London* | 2013-2017

Public Service Department Scholarship | *Malaysian government* | 2011-2016